of 9 million Hindus who remained in East Pakistan. By November 1952, the refugee influx had ended, 80,000 refugees remained in camps, and a new passport system was started. When the CPI started an 'Indo-Pak friendship week', the Jan Sangh's S.P. Mookerjee rejected it, questioning how agreements could be reached with a 'persistent wrong-doer'. He suggested that the communists could go to East Pakistan 'with their families' and try to mobilise public opinion against the passport system. Speaking at the All India Convention for Minority Rights, Mookerjee called for the passport system to be withdrawn.

His hard line on East Pakistan was predicated on three reasons. Hindus, he argued, were being converted in many parts of Pakistan. Nehru's approach of providing a 'healing touch', he dismissed scornfully as 'quack remedies'. And finally, the public mind was 'deeply agitated over the whole problem of the fate of minorities in Eastern Pakistan'.[66]

This is why, in 1956, the Sangh passed a resolution saying it was 'profoundly shocked' at the 'sudden reversal of the Government of India's policy with respect to the exodus of Hindus from East Bengal and restricting the issuance of migration certificates to Hindu migrants'. This virtual banning of Hindu migration from East Bengal 'at the behest of Pakistan', the resolution said, 'has indeed been an abject surrender to the forces of communalism let loose in the Islamic Republic, and it is calculated to result in the extermination of the Hindus in East Bengal'. It urged the government to give up the 'weak-kneed' policy immediately.[67]

The debate over the BJP's CAA in 2019-20 occurred in a very different India from that of the 1950s. Yet, the idea underpinning it lies at the very heart of the primary political fault-line on Pakistan's Hindu minorities that led to the founding of the Jan Sangh itself. The BJP may have politically overextended itself in 2019 with the twinning of CAA, meant for religious minorities in Pakistan, with a future NRC, which was meant to detect and deport illegal migrants already in India. The NRC was to follow in a 'chronology', said the home minister, after CAA. When this ignited nationwide protests and raised fears over the citizenship of minorities, the BJP seemed to put